



Volcanoes

Volcanoes are openings in the Earth's crust. Sometimes magma (melted rock) from just beneath the crust bursts through these openings as a volcanic eruption. Lots of ash and dust shoot out too.



Making mountains

The Himalayas started to form 50 million years ago, when two moving plates collided. The mountains are still growing!

Fault lines

Earthquakes happen when "plates" rub against each other.

Earthquakes often occur along the San Andreas Fault.

Drifting continents

The world hasn't always looked like it does now. Millions of years ago, all the land was joined together. Slowly, it broke up and the continents drifted apart.



200 million years ago



135 million years ago



10 million years ago

Cracked crust

Earth's top layer is made up of giant pieces called "plates".

These fit together a bit like a jigsaw, but they're constantly moving. Volcanoes and earthquakes often happen in the weak spots where plates move against each other.

